ACROBATICS (5E, 2024 RULES) – DESCRIPTION

Acrobatics is a **Dexterity** skill. It is used to **stay on your feet** when balance is precarious (ice, a tightrope, a pitching ship's deck) or to perform an **acrobatic stunt** (a dive, a roll, a flip). The DM asks for a roll when the outcome is **uncertain** and **interesting**.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. An Acrobatics check is an **ability check**: d20 + Dexterity modifier (+ Proficiency Bonus if proficient).
2. The **DM sets the DC** using the official scale: 5, 10, 15, 20, 25, 30.
3. On an ability check, a **20** or a **1** has no special effect: no critical here.
4. Acrobatics appears in several rules: **landing**, **falling into water**, **escaping a grapple**.
5. A failure often leads to another: Prone, a fall, damage (**Tables** page).

⚠ Using another ability:

- The ability of a check is **decided by the situation**. For example, Acrobatics can pair with **Strength** (pulling up) or **Constitution** (holding a balance for a long time). Table rule
- The **Proficiency Bonus** applies when the skill **fits** and you are proficient.
- See the **Use cases** page and the **Athletics** sheet.

⚠ Change from 2014

Acrobatics is cited by several specific rules: **landing** in Difficult Terrain (DC 10), **falling into water** (DC 15), and **escaping a grapple**, which uses a **fixed DC**.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

Few tasks have an official DC, and nothing says whether Acrobatics lets you **move through an enemy's space** or avoid an **opportunity attack**. Fix: the **DM announces** the ability, the skill, and the DC **before** the roll.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

Describe the **momentum**: the body twisting in midair, the roll that absorbs the fall, the foot finding the rope at the last second.

Step 1 – Decide whether a roll is needed:

A roll happens only if the outcome is **uncertain** and **interesting**: precarious balance or a difficult stunt. Walking on a wide beam needs no roll.

Step 2 – Choose the ability and the skill:

By default: **Dexterity (Acrobatics)**. The DM may pair **another ability** if the situation demands it, and says whether proficiency applies.

Step 3 – Set the DC:

The task is...	DC
Very easy	5
Easy	10
Moderate	15
Hard	20
Very hard	25
Nearly impossible	30

Step 4 – Make the roll:

d20 + Dexterity modifier + **Proficiency Bonus** if you are proficient in Acrobatics. An ally can use the **Help** action to give you **Advantage**.

Example: Lysa (Dexterity +4, Proficiency +2) crosses a tightrope over a river (DC 15). She rolls 9 + 4 + 2 = 15: success.

Step 5 – Resolve and chain:

- **Total ≥ DC**: the attempt succeeds.
- **Total < DC**: it fails. Often the consequence is the **Prone** condition or a **fall** (next page).
- A 20 or a 1 on the d20 **changes nothing** on an ability check.

ACROBATICS (5E, 2024 RULES) – TABLES

Acrobatics uses in the 2024 rules:

Situation	Check and DC
Stay on your feet in a precarious situation (ice, tightrope, pitching deck)	Dexterity (Acrobatics), DC set by the DM
Perform an acrobatic stunt (dive, roll, flip)	Dexterity (Acrobatics), DC set by the DM
Land in Difficult Terrain after a Long Jump	Dexterity (Acrobatics) **DC 10**, otherwise Prone
Fall into water (Reaction)	Strength (Athletics) or Dexterity (Acrobatics) **DC 15**: fall damage halved
Escape a grapple (action)	Strength (Athletics) or Dexterity (Acrobatics) against **the grapple's DC**

When one use case leads to another:

First check	Consequence	Next use case
Landing in Difficult Terrain (DC 10)	Failure: Prone	Standing up costs half your Speed
Precarious balance	Failure: Prone or a fall	Fall damage: 1d6 per 10 feet (HP sheet)
Fall into water (DC 15)	Success: damage halved	Swimming, breath, suffocation (Swimming sheet)
Grapple escape	Success: no longer Grappled	Free movement (Grappling sheet)
Long Jump (Athletics)	Success: you land	Landing in Difficult Terrain (Acrobatics)

Chain example: Lysa jumps over a river (Athletics). The landing is in Difficult Terrain: Acrobatics DC 10. She rolls 2 + 4 + 2 = 8: failure, she falls Prone and must spend half her Speed to stand up.

Ability + skill combinations: Table rule

*The DM decides the ability by the situation and applies proficiency if it fits. These combinations are **exceptions announced before the roll**.*

Combination	Use in play
Strength (Acrobatics)	Hold a balance or pull up by strength rather than agility (a plank, a muscle-up).
Constitution (Acrobatics)	Stay in precarious balance for a very long time (tightrope, pole) without wavering.
Intelligence (Acrobatics)	Calculate a trajectory or a complex routine before performing it.
Wisdom (Acrobatics)	Sense your center of gravity and anticipate a slip to catch yourself.
Charisma (Acrobatics)	A circus or street act before an audience to impress it.
Dexterity (Performance)	An acrobatic dance or balancing act where art matters as much as technique.
Dexterity (Athletics)	Sprint, obstacle course, or technical hurdle.

How to choose: Table rule

1. What does the task demand: **power, agility, endurance, mind, presence**? That gives the ability.
2. Which skill describes the **know-how**? Apply proficiency if it fits.
3. The DM **announces** the combination and the DC before the roll.

*Example: Brann (Constitution +3, Acrobatics proficiency +2) holds his balance on a pole for 10 minutes, DC 15. He rolls 8 + 3 + 2 = 13: failure, he loses his balance. See also the combinations in the **Athletics** sheet.*

Common table questions.

Acrobatics or Athletics?

Acrobatics: balance and acrobatic feats. **Athletics**: power. To escape a grapple or when falling into water, the player chooses either.

Can I use Acrobatics with another ability?

Yes: the ability is decided by the situation. See the **Use cases** page (Strength, Constitution, Charisma…). Table rule

Do I need a roll to walk a tightrope?

Yes if balance is precarious and the outcome uncertain. A wide beam or a stable bridge needs none.

Is a 20 an automatic success?

No: on an ability check, a **20** or a **1** has no special effect.

What if I fail a landing?

You are **Prone**. Standing up costs half your Speed.

Can I roll through an enemy's space?

The rules don't provide it with Acrobatics: the DM may allow it, with an announced DC. Table rule

Does Acrobatics avoid an opportunity attack?

No: that is the job of the **Disengage** action.

Does Acrobatics reduce fall damage?

Only for a fall into water (DC 15, half). Otherwise, 1d6 per 10 feet.

Which features help?

Expertise doubles the Proficiency Bonus. The Rogue can treat a 9 or lower as a 10. The **Help** action gives Advantage.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

20 and 1 on a check

On an ability check, a 20 or a 1 has no special effect: no Critical Hit, no automatic failure.

Moving through a Prone enemy

Being Prone changes nothing: you pass through an enemy's space only if it is Incapacitated, Tiny, or two sizes apart.

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